

**March 5, 2026**

**Postal Regulatory Commission (PRC)**

**901 New York Ave NW Ste 200**

**Washington DC 20268**

**Re: Order No. 9427 (Dockets # RM2024-4, RM2022-5, RM2022-6, RM2021-2)**

**Dear Postal Regulatory Commissioners:**

We appreciate the opportunity to provide these comments in response to PRC Order No. 9427, which invites stakeholders to respond to the Postal Service's petition seeking the complete removal of the CPI price cap, or, alternatively, granting it an additional 23 percentage points of rate authority. We oppose the Postal Service's proposals, as outlined below.

This letter is being submitted by the undersigned individuals and organizations as an important part of these comment proceedings to underscore the common principles and concerns of the mailing community and its industry members.

We represent a significant number of mailing customers across all rate classes that have been paying increasing rates while seeing service declines. Meantime, we continuously seek ways to remain in the postal system and sincerely hope that the Postal Regulatory Commission, through its mandated statutory oversight, can help shape a sustainable path forward.

Therefore, it is vital that we put our common concerns and positions before you, as we hope to have a vital stake in the success of the United States Postal Service for many decades ahead.

We outline our shared positions and concerns below:

**USPS & Regulatory Oversight:**

The role of the USPS must continue as a regulated monopoly with strong oversight by the Postal Regulatory Commission. As a regulated monopoly with a vital mission to serve all communities, including the most rural and remote areas in the United States, ensuring there is oversight in the event of monopoly overreach is key. This must occur frequently and with input from the mail senders and recipients since the USPS is dependent on its stakeholders for its financial outcomes. Without such review, a monopoly has an incentive to attempt to increase profitability through price increases and service declines to sustain itself.

We do not support removing such oversight as the USPS is seeking in its petitions before the PRC. Our experience points to a need for more, not less, oversight, particularly as the USPS is redesigning its network, and as the USPS is failing in shifting course. The USPS track record over the five years of the “Delivering for America” (DFA) plan simply does not merit the unrestricted authority it seeks given its quite large and persistent financial losses coupled with the worst outcomes on total factor productivity since measurement started in 1972. This is a plan, in our view, that has failed. The USPS’ costs are escalating, its productivity is deteriorating, its revenues and volumes are declining, and the need for a strong regulator has never been more important.

### **Price Caps & PRC Review:**

As the Commission knows, the rate setting process has changed dramatically over the years, from the 1970 Postal Reorganization Act creating the Postal Rate Commission, to the 2006 PAEA which maintained and expanded the Commission’s authority, and the 2022 PRSA that continued this approach. Through this record, it is plain that the United States Congress supports the need for regulation and oversight of the USPS’ monopolies and has trusted the Commission in that role.

As our individual comments to the Commission indicate, we largely support a return to a CPI-cap rate system, with some supporting performance-based incentives to allow the USPS rate authority in addition to the CPI cap. We are all in agreement, however, that the CPI cap should not be removed as the USPS proposes because it would be disastrous for the USPS and its customers. We have all lived in a system lacking a rate cap, which led to great uncertainty for users of the USPS. The ability to plan mail campaigns in advance and to determine mailing budgets became difficult and led to an unstable postal system. Certainty and predictability, as recognized by Congress, are keystones of the current system.

We are also all in agreement that the density additional rate authority needs to be eliminated. In practice it has varied widely, contributing to unpredictable and unstable price increases, and it has accelerated volume declines. Mailers have responded to this additional price increase by mailing less to more expensive geographical areas.

### **Cost Controls and Efficiency Improvements:**

We also collectively share our concerns that as we pay higher prices and experience reduced service, there appears to be minimal review of the USPS’ increasing costs and decreasing efficiency. Mail volume decline cannot be arbitrarily blamed on the “digital revolution,” as it has for the past decades. The USPS needs to significantly reduce its costs

and improve its efficiency to support lower price increases which, in turn, will help retain and grow mail volumes.

Action is needed now to grow traditional, efficient physical mail as postal customers have even more options to use digital but are currently willing to remain in a postal system that provides affordable and reliable mailing products; something we urge the Commission assist with through its oversight.

**Summary:**

In conclusion, we believe that the preservation of a regulated CPI price cap regime for the USPS' monopoly products is the best model to provide an environment with incentive for the USPS to drive down costs and improve efficiencies. That will reward the regulated monopoly through better results rather than enabling a lack of accountability that will escalate costs.

In addition to pricing, we urge the PRC to review related concerns with postal service efficiency and cost management to ensure that this regulated monopoly is not taking steps to reduce service that ratepayers have been promised and expect.

We appreciate your review of these comments, and we eagerly await your conclusions in this important proceeding.

Respectfully Submitted,

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